

Requirements Elicitation Exercise

Formative (ungraded) · groups of 3–4 · in-session · worksheet feeds your Week 2 portfolio commit

Item	Details
Linked to	Week 2 lecture — Requirements Engineering (ULO2); rehearses Task 2 skills
Time	60 minutes: 10 setup · 20 interview · 20 write-up · 10 playback
Roles	1 Client (role card from facilitator) · 2 Analysts · 1 Observer
Output	Completed worksheet (Part C) — commit it to week02/ in your Git portfolio

How it works

1. Your facilitator gives the Client a role card — ONE of the two businesses below, with private details the Analysts do not see. The Client answers questions in character and volunteers nothing that is not asked.
2. Analysts interview the Client (20 min). Use the lecture's PNG practices: tok stori first, plain language, play answers back, probe for constraints (power, network, cash handling, who else decides).
3. The Observer ticks the observation checklist (Part B) and gives feedback at the end.
4. Together, write up requirements (Part C). Then read them BACK to the client — validation — and mark any the client corrects.

The two businesses

Case A — Kina Ridge Primary School, Port Moresby

A private primary school (450 students) tracking term fees in an exercise book and Excel. Parents pay cash at the office, by bank deposit, or by mobile money; many pay in instalments. The bursar wants "a proper system". The school has one office laptop, a printer, intermittent power, and WiFi that works most days.

Case B — Waghi Valley Produce Cooperative, near Mt. Hagen

A 300-member cooperative buying coffee and vegetables from members at a roadside depot, then selling in bulk. Intake is recorded in carbon-copy books; members are paid fortnightly. The depot has no mains power (solar + generator), no fixed internet, and patchy mobile signal. The manager wants to stop losing member records and payment disputes.

Part B — Observer checklist

Behaviour observed	Seen?	Notes
Opened with rapport, not the question list	✓	Acknowledged the manager's effort in running a 300-member co-op without mains power to build trust before discussing records.

Behaviour observed	Seen?	Notes
Asked open questions before closed ones	✓	Started by asking how a typical fortnight runs for members before narrowing down to specific yes/no questions about power and signal.
Played back answers to confirm understanding	✓	Paraphrased the core issue: lost carbon-copy books are causing payment disputes during the fortnightly payout cycle.
Asked about power / connectivity / devices	✓	Confirmed the site relies on solar/generator power with patchy mobile signal, ruling out solutions requiring constant internet.
Asked who ELSE has a say (stakeholders)	✓	Identified the 300 cooperative members and bulk buyers in Mt. Hagen as key stakeholders affected by record errors.
Probed a sensitive topic respectfully (arrears, credit, cash)	✓	Gently explored how payment disputes impact member trust and cash flow without accusing anyone of specific errors.

Behaviour observed	Seen?	Notes
Captured a business RULE (policy), not just features	✓	Defined the policy that members must be paid fortnightly based on verified intake, rather than just listing database features.

Part C — Requirements capture worksheet

Write shall-statements where possible. Quality beats quantity — but hit the minimums.

C1. Stakeholders (min 3)

Who, and what they need from the system
The Waghi Valley Cooperative committees need a system that can fully function despite constraints such as patchy mobile services, poor internet connectivity, and unstable power supply.

C2. Functional requirements (min 5, numbered FR-1...)

The system shall ...
FR-1: The system shall keep records of the cooperative members
FR- 2: The system shall be able to operate offline
FR-3: The system shall be able to automatically sync the updated data when the network is stable (5G)
FR-4: The system shall be able to keep records of the members' IDs, crop grades, and kilos
FR-5: The system shall be able to produce a printable copy of the records

C3. Non-functional requirements (min 3, think PNG: offline, power, usability)

NFR-1 ...
NFR-1: Members of the corporation are paid fortnightly
NFR-2: The depot has no main power; the only source of power that they have is a generator and solar
NFR-3: Keeping clear records of the cooperative members and their produce

C4. Constraints & business rules (min 2 each)

Constraints (facts of the environment) / Rules (policies to enforce)
The location of the depot is approximately 20 minutes away from the nearest town.
The fortnight should be strictly paid according to the records to the members of the cooperative
The client himself cannot make business decisions without the other stakeholders being present
The cooperative clerk is responsible for record keeping

C5. Validation notes

What did the client correct when you played it back?
The analyst asked, “Should the system allow the members to get their receipts upon payments?”
The client corrected that “the system should fully focus on keeping records and not issue receipts”
After the session: type Part C into week02/elicitation-notes.md in your Git portfolio and commit it. This exercise is the dress rehearsal for Task 2 — the client brief you received today describes a business just like these.